cetz-spline

Advanced Curve Geometry and Splines for CeTZ

Version: 0.1.0 **Compiler:** ≥ 0.15.0 **CeTZ:** 0.5.3 **License:** MIT

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1 Overview

`cetz-spline` provides a mathematically rigorous spline and curve geometry library built specifically for the CeTZ canvas ecosystem.

CeTZ already includes 2D/3D vector mathematics (`cetz.vector`), basic cubic Bézier evaluation (`cubic-point`, `cubic-derivative`), and de Casteljau curve splitting (`split`). `cetz-spline` directly re-uses those primitives and focuses strictly on higher-order geometric operations that CeTZ does not provide:

- **Centripetal and Chordal Catmull-Rom Parameterization** ($\alpha = 0.5, 1.0$): CeTZ only implements uniform Catmull-Rom ($\alpha = 0$), which produces self-intersections and loops around sharp corners. Centripetal parameterization prevents cusps and self-intersections within regular individual segments.
- **Second Derivatives and Curvature Fields**: Piecewise acceleration vectors $C''(u)$, oriented left unit normal fields $\boldsymbol{N}(u)$, and signed scalar curvature $\kappa(u)$.
- **Arbitrary-Degree B-Splines**: Cox-de Boor evaluation with cubic conversion for degrees up to three and cubic approximation for higher degrees.
- **High-Precision Arc Length**: 5-point Gauss-Legendre numerical quadrature with Newton-Raphson distance inversion ($s \mapsto t$).
- **Parallel Offset Curves**: Normal-offset curves $C(u) + d \cdot \boldsymbol{N}(u)$ with curvature-scaled tangent matching.
- **Homotopies and Deformation Vector Fields**: Morphing families $(1-t)A + tB$ and directional deformation vectors connecting curves at equal arc-length fractions.
- **CAD-Style Geometric Visualizers**: Curvature needles and envelope curves, unit tangent vectors, normal fields, and control polygons.

CeTZ supplies the canvas, paths, transforms, and coordinate system. This package adds reusable spline objects, geometric analysis, distance queries, and drawing helpers. Import the package as `cs` to avoid collisions between geometric transformations such as `cs.scale` and CeTZ canvas transformations such as `cetz.draw.scale`.

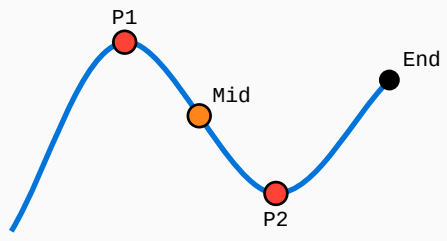
2 Getting Started

2.1 Usage

Import `cetz` and `cetz-spline` into your document:

```
#import "@preview/cetz:0.5.3"
#import "@preview/cetz-spline:0.1.0" as cs
```

Spline rendering functions are typically called inside a CeTZ canvas block:




```
let pts = ((0, 0), (1.5, 2.5), (3.5, 0.5), (5,
2))
let sp = cs.spline-catmull(pts, alpha: 0.5)

spline(sp, name: "c", stroke: 2pt + blue)
circle("c.pt-1", radius: 0.15, fill: red)
circle("c.pt-2", radius: 0.15, fill: red)
circle("c.mid", radius: 0.15, fill: orange)
circle("c.end", radius: 0.12, fill: black)
content("c.pt-1", text(size: 8pt, fill: black)
[P1], anchor: "south", padding: 7pt)
content("c.pt-2", text(size: 8pt, fill: black)
[P2], anchor: "north", padding: 7pt)
content("c.mid", text(size: 8pt, fill: black)
[Mid], anchor: "south-west", padding: 5pt)
content("c.end", text(size: 8pt, fill: black)
[End], anchor: "south-west", padding: 5pt)
```

2.2 Named Anchors

When `name: "..."` is passed to `cs.draw.spline`, the following named anchors are injected:

- `"start"`, `"end"`: curve extremities
- `"mid"`: midpoint at global parameter $t = 0.5$
- `"pt-<idx>"`: original control points (`"pt-0"`, `"pt-1"`, …)
- `"t(X%)"`: position at parameter ratio (e.g. `"t(25%)"`, `"t(50%)"`, `"t(75%)"`)
- `"s(X%)"`: position at numerical arc-length ratio (e.g. `"s(50%)"`)
- `"50%"`, `"25%"`, `"75%"`: standard CeTZ path percentage anchors

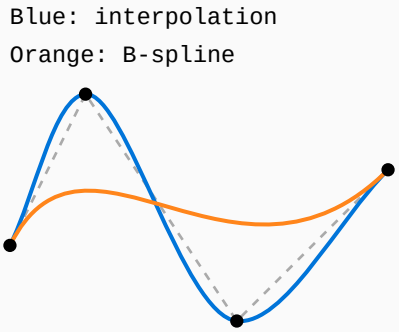
3 Practical Guide

3.1 Choose the Curve for the Task

Use `cs.spline-catmull` when the curve must pass through every data point, for example a route or a measured profile. Start with `alpha: 0.5`; `alpha: 0` and `alpha: 1` are useful comparisons, not universal improvements. Use `cs.spline-bspline` when the points should act as a control polygon: interior points generally do not lie on the curve. Open clamped B-splines interpolate their first and last points. Closed curves wrap automatically; do not repeat the first point at the end.

3.2 Interpolation versus Control Points

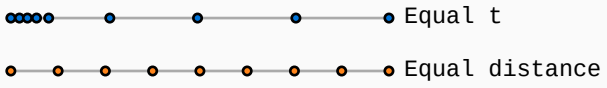
Both curves below use the same points. Blue interpolates them; orange is pulled towards them. The dashed polygon is the input data, rather than the individual cubic handle polygons.




```
let pts = ((0, 0), (1, 2), (3, -1), (5, 1))
line(..pts, stroke: (paint: gray, dash: "dashed"))
spline(cs.spline-catmull(pts), stroke: 1.5pt + blue)
spline(cs.spline-bspline(pts), stroke: 1.5pt + orange)
for pt in pts { circle(pt, radius: 0.07, fill: black) }
content((0, 3), [Blue: interpolation], anchor: "west")
content((0, 2.5), [Orange: B-spline], anchor: "west")
```

3.3 Place Markers at Equal Distances

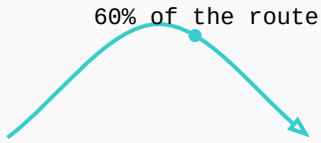
A parameter midpoint is not necessarily halfway along the curve. In the upper row below, equal t steps cluster on the short first segment. In the lower row, equal distance fractions give evenly spaced markers along the same geometry. These are distances along the curve, rather than straight-line distances between markers.




```
let sp = cs.with-lut(cs.spline-catmull(((0, 0), (0.5, 0), (5, 0))))
spline(sp, name: "t", stroke: gray)
let shifted = cs.translate(sp, (0, -0.7))
spline(shifted, name: "s", stroke: gray)
for i in range(0, 9) {
  let pct = str(i * 12.5) + "%"
  circle("t.t(" + pct + ")", radius: 0.055, fill: blue)
  circle("s.s(" + pct + ")", radius: 0.055, fill: orange)
}
content((5.2, 0), [Equal t], anchor: "west")
content((5.2, -0.7), [Equal distance], anchor: "west")
```

3.4 Label a Curve and Inherit Canvas Styles

The label anchor is chosen from the left normal so the text sits beside the curve. Use `side: -1` for the opposite side. Distance values in analytical functions are absolute canvas units; `.s(50%)` is a fraction of total length.




```
let sp = cs.with-lut(cs.spline-catmull(((0, 0), (2, 1.5), (4, 0))))
set-style(stroke: (paint: teal, thickness: 1.5pt))
spline(sp, name: "route", mark: (end: ">"))
let d = cs.spline-arc-length(sp) * 0.6
circle("route.s(60%)", radius: 0.06, fill: teal)
content("route.s(60%)", [60% of the route],
  anchor: cs.spline-label-anchor-at-distance(sp, d), padding: 0.15)
```

3.5 Numerical and API Conventions

Each stored cubic receives the same share of global t. Position and distance queries clamp to the curve domain. Reversing arc-length integration limits returns a negative length. Numeric `.s(0.5)` and `.t(0.5)` mean fractions; write percentages explicitly to avoid ambiguity. Legacy numeric anchor values above one are interpreted as percentages. Bare percentage anchors mean parameter fractions in this package.

Sampling counts must be integers (`resample`: at least two; comb: at least three; homotopy resampling: at least four). Homotopy inputs must both be open or both closed. The arc-length mode rebuilds an interpolating curve through sampled correspondences, so it is an approximation. For closed curves, align their start points and traversal directions before morphing.

The mathematical notes at the end explain continuity, orientation, and numerical limitations. They are optional for drawing and labeling curves.

4 API Reference

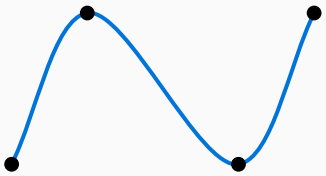
4.1 Spline Constructors

```
spline-catmull(
  points array,
  alpha float = 0.5,
  closed bool = false,
  boundary str = "clamped"
) → spline
```

Constructs a Catmull-Rom spline through a list of points using generalized knot spacing.

Parameters

- **`points`** `array`
  Array of 2D coordinates `((x0, y0), (x1, y1), ...)`.
- **`alpha`** `float`
  Knot exponent: `0.0` (uniform), `0.5` (centripetal, default), or `1.0` (chordal).
- **`closed`** `bool`
  Whether the curve is a closed periodic loop.
- **`boundary`** `str`
  Open endpoint treatment: `"clamped"` extrapolates virtual points along endpoint chords; it does not prescribe a user-supplied derivative. `"natural"` adjusts exterior handles to give zero second derivatives at both ends.



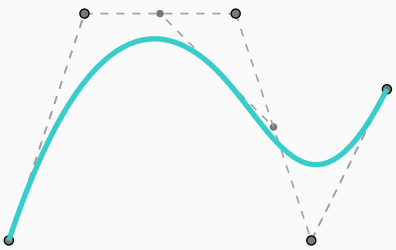
```
let pts = ((0, 0), (1, 2), (3, 0), (4, 2))
let sp = cs.spline-catmull(pts, alpha: 0.5)
spline(sp, stroke: 1.5pt + blue)
for pt in pts { circle(pt, radius: 0.08, fill:
black) }
```

```
spline-bspline(
  points array,
  degree int = 3,
  closed bool = false,
  knots array
) → spline
```

Constructs a B-spline via Cox-de Boor recursion. Degrees up to three have exact cubic representations; higher degrees are approximated. The effective degree is limited to the number of points minus one.

Parameters

- **`points`** `array`
  Array of control polygon vertices.
- **`degree`** `int`
  Polynomial degree (default: 3 for cubic B-spline).
- **`closed`** `bool`
  Whether the spline forms a closed periodic loop.
- **`knots`** `array`
  Optional custom knot vector. Defaults to clamped open-uniform knots.



```
let pts = ((0, 0), (1, 3), (3, 3), (4, 0), (5, 2))
let sp = cs.spline-bspline(pts, degree: 3)
draw-control-polygon(sp)
spline(sp, stroke: 2pt + teal)
```

4.2 Analytical Evaluation

```
spline-eval(
  spline spline,
  t float
) → point
```

Evaluates position $C(t) \in \mathbb{R}^2$ on the spline for parameter $t \in [0, 1]$.

Parameters

- **spline** `spline`
  Target spline dictionary.
- **t** `float`
  Global parameter in range $[0, 1]$.

```
spline-derivative(
  spline spline,
  t float
) → vector
```

Computes velocity vector $C'(t) = \frac{dC}{dt}$ scaled with respect to global parameter t.

```
spline-second-derivative(
  spline spline,
  t float
) → vector
```

Computes acceleration vector $C''(t) = \frac{d^2C}{dt^2}$.

```
spline-tangent(
  spline spline,
  t float
) → vector
```

Computes normalized unit tangent vector $\boldsymbol{T}(t) = \frac{C'(t)}{\|C'(t)\|}$.

```
spline-normal(
  spline spline,
  t float
) → vector
```

Computes oriented left unit normal vector $\boldsymbol{N}(t) = \big(-T_y, T_x\big)$.

```
spline-curvature(
  spline spline,
  t float
) → float
```

Computes signed scalar curvature $\kappa(t) = \frac{x'y'' - y'x''}{(x'^2 + y'^2)^{\frac{3}{2}}}$.

```
spline-normal-angle(
  spline spline,
  t float
) → angle
```

Computes the direction angle of the unit normal vector $\boldsymbol{N}(t)$ as a Typst `angle` (e.g. `90deg`, `-45deg`). Ideal for orienting perpendicular annotations, ticks, and CeTZ label anchors.

```
spline-tangent-angle(
  spline spline,
  t float
) → angle
```

Computes the direction angle of the unit tangent vector $\boldsymbol{T}(t)$ as a Typst `angle`. Useful for vehicle heading, arrow alignment, and flow orientations.

```
spline-label-anchor(
  spline spline,
  t float,
  side int = 1
) → angle
```

Computes the optimal CeTZ `content` anchor angle to position text cleanly along the curve normal without colliding with the stroke. If `side` is 1 (default), returns `spline-normal-angle + 180deg` (places text on the outer normal side). If `side` is −1, returns `spline-normal-angle` (places text on the inner side).

4.3 Arc Length & Inversion

```
spline-arc-length(
  spline spline,
  t1 float = 0.0,
  t2 float = 1.0
) → float
```

Computes arc length between parameters t_1 and t_2 via 5-point Gauss-Legendre quadrature.

```
spline-t-for-distance(
  spline spline,
  distance float
) → float
```

Finds parameter $t \in [0, 1]$ corresponding to physical distance along the curve using Newton-Raphson iteration.

```
spline-point-at-distance(
  spline spline,
  distance float
) → point
```

Evaluates point $C(s)$ at physical distance s from curve start.

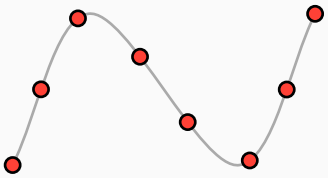
4.4 Geometric Operations

```
resample(
  spline spline,
  count int
) → array
```

Resamples the curve into `count` points spaced uniformly by physical arc length.

Parameters

- **`spline`** `spline`
  Target spline.
- **`count`** `int`
  Number of equidistant sample points (≥ 2).



```
let sp = cs.spline-catmull(((0, 0), (1, 2), (3,
0), (4, 2)))
let pts = cs.resample(sp, 8)
spline(sp, stroke: 1pt + gray)
for p in pts { circle(p, radius: 0.1, fill:
red) }
```

```
homotopy(
  spline-a spline,
  spline-b spline,
  t float,
  mode str = "auto",
  samples int, auto = auto
) → spline
```

Computes intermediate morphed spline under linear homotopy $(1-t)A + tB$.

Parameters

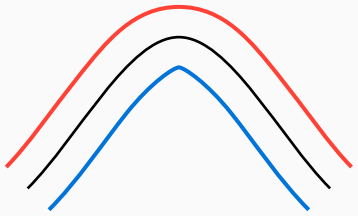
- **`spline-a`** `spline`
  Base source spline ($t = 0$).
- **`spline-b`** `spline`
  Target destination spline ($t = 1$).
- **`t`** `float`
  Homotopy parameter in $[0, 1]$.
- **`mode`** `str`
  Interpolation strategy:
  - `"auto"` (default): uses `"segment"` if segment counts and closedness match; otherwise resamples by arc length.
  - `"segment"`: forces direct segment-by-segment Bézier control point interpolation.
  - `"arc-length"` (or `"length"`): forces uniform physical arc-length resampling before morphing, ensuring points at distance fraction s morph directly to distance fraction s on the target curve. Useful when segment lengths vary significantly between curves (e.g. $[0, 1, 8]$ to $[0, 7, 8]$) to prevent non-uniform stretching waves.
- **`samples`** `int, auto`
  Resample count when in `"arc-length"` mode (default: `auto`, picking $\max(4N_A, 4N_B, 32)$).

```
offset(
  spline spline,
  distance float,
  subdivide bool = true
) → spline
```

Approximates the normal offset $C(u) + d \cdot \boldsymbol{N}(u)$ using endpoint positions and curvature-scaled tangent handles. No approximation error bound or intersection removal is provided.

Parameters

- **`spline`** `spline`
  Base curve.
- **`distance`** `float`
  Perpendicular offset distance (positive: left, negative: right).
- **`subdivide`** `bool`
  Whether to split segments with high curvature variation.



```
let sp = cs.spline-catmull(((0, 0), (2, 2), (4, 0)))
let left = cs.offset(sp, 0.4)
let right = cs.offset(sp, -0.4)

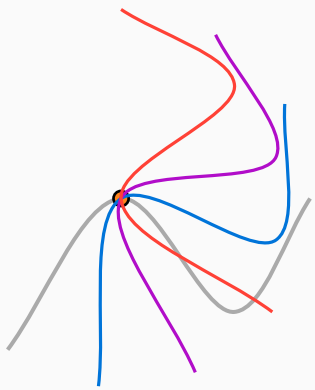
spline(left, stroke: 1.5pt + red)
spline(sp, stroke: 1pt + black)
spline(right, stroke: 1.5pt + blue)
```

```
rotate-spline(
  spline spline,
  angle angle, float,
  origin point = (0.0, 0.0)
) → spline
```

Rotates a spline rigidly by `angle` around an `origin` pivot point. Because Bézier curves are affine-invariant, all segment endpoints and control handles are transformed exactly without numerical approximation, preserving parameterization and arc lengths. Also aliased as `rotate`.

Parameters

- **`spline`** `spline`
  Target spline dictionary.
- **`angle`** `angle, float`
  Rotation angle (e.g. `45deg`, `-90deg`, or radians as float).
- **`origin`** `point`
  Pivot point of rotation (default: `(0, 0)`).



```
let sp = cs.spline-catmull(((0, 0), (1.5, 2), (3, 0.5), (4, 2)))
let piv = (1.5, 2)

spline(sp, stroke: 1.5pt + gray)
circle(piv, radius: 0.1, fill: orange)

for (i, a) in (30deg, 60deg, 90deg).enumerate()
{
  let rot = cs.rotate-spline(sp, a, origin: piv)
  let clr = (blue, purple, red).at(i)
  spline(rot, stroke: 1.2pt + clr)
}
```

```
translate-spline(
  spline spline,
  offset point
) → spline
```

Translates a spline rigidly by a 2D delta vector `offset = (dx, dy)`. Preserves arc lengths and lookup tables. Also aliased as `translate`.

Parameters

- **`spline`** `spline`
  Target spline dictionary.
- **`offset`** `point`
  Translation offset vector `(dx, dy)`.

```
scale-spline(
  spline spline,
  factor float, array,
  origin point = (0.0, 0.0),
  dir any
) → spline
```

Scales a spline relative to `origin`. Supports negative factors for reflections, as well as directional scaling along an arbitrary vector or angle `dir`. Resets the arc-length lookup table for automatic lazy rebuild. Also aliased as `scale`.

Parameters

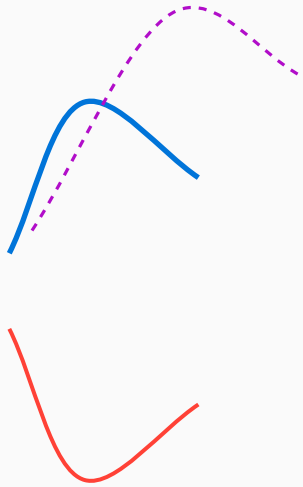
- **`spline`** `spline`
  Target spline dictionary.
- **`factor`** `float, array`
  Scale factor. If `dir` is `none`, a float scales uniformly, or `(sx, sy)` scales along axes. If `dir` is specified, a float scales along `dir`, or `(su, sv)` scales along `dir` and its normal.
- **`origin`** `point`
  Center point of scaling (default: `(0, 0)`).
- **`dir`** `str, array, angle, none`
  Optional direction vector `(dx, dy)`, angle (e.g. `45deg`), or `"x"` / `"y"`. Default: `none`.

```
mirror-spline(
  spline spline,
  origin point = (0.0, 0.0),
  axis any = "x"
) → spline
```

Mirrors (reflects) a spline across a line passing through `origin` or performs point reflection. Also aliased as `mirror`.

Parameters

- **`spline`** `spline`
  Target spline dictionary.
- **`origin`** `point`
  Point that the reflection axis/center passes through (default: `(0, 0)`).
- **`axis`** `str, array, angle, none`
  Reflection axis: `"x"` (horizontal line, flips y), `"y"` (vertical line, flips x), a direction vector `(dx, dy)`, an `angle` (e.g. `45deg`), or `none` for point reflection.



```
let sp = cs.spline-catmull(((0.5, 0.5), (1.5,
2.5), (3, 1.5)))

spline(sp, stroke: 2pt + blue)

// Mirror across x-axis
let mir-x = cs.mirror-spline(sp, axis: "x")
spline(mir-x, stroke: 1.5pt + red)

// Directional scale along (1, 1) direction
let sc-dir = cs.scale-spline(sp, 1.6, origin:
(0, 0), dir: (1, 1))
spline(sc-dir, stroke: (paint: purple,
thickness: 1.2pt, dash: "dashed"))
```

4.5 Canvas Drawing Functions

```
draw.spline(
  spline-obj any,
  name str,
  stroke stroke = auto,
  fill paint = auto,
  close bool = false,
  mark any = auto,
  ..style any
) → element
```

CeTZ canvas drawing element. Accepts either a spline dictionary or an array of points. When a `name` is provided, automatically injects named anchors into CeTZ's coordinate resolution system.

Styles are inherited from CeTZ with `auto` defaults. Pass `stroke`, `fill`, `fill-rule`, `mark`, or `shorten` as supported by CeTZ's merged paths. Use `none` to suppress stroke, fill, or marks explicitly. Stroke dictionaries support paint, thickness,

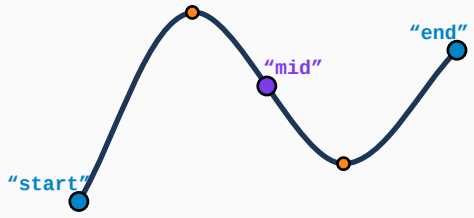
dash, cap, and join. `draw-tangents`, `draw-normals`, and `draw-homotopy-field` forward extra named styles to their line elements; composite decorations expose separate styles for their parts.

`close: true` on an existing open spline adds a straight closing path for rendering. It does not change the spline dictionary, evaluations, or distance anchors. To interpolate a smooth loop, construct it with `closed: true`. Points are numeric 2D canvas coordinates; a third coordinate is discarded. Arbitrary CeTZ anchor coordinates cannot be used as constructor input.

Dynamic Named Anchors

When a spline element is assigned a `name` (e.g. `spline(sp, name: "my-curve")`), CeTZ intercepts the coordinate lookup and dynamically evaluates requested anchor queries on the fly without precomputed limits:

Anchor Pattern	Description
`"start"`, `"end"`	First and last endpoints of the spline.
`"mid"`, `"default"`	Midpoint evaluated at parameter $t = 0.5$ (`"default"` matches `"start"`).
`"pt-0"`, `"pt-1"`, …	Original control points or segment boundary endpoints.
`"t(<val>)"`	Dynamic polynomial parameter space position $t \in [0, 1]$ or percentage $X\%$ (e.g. `"t(0.42)"`, `"t(50%)"`, `"t(33.3%)"`).
`"s(<val>)"`	Dynamic physical arc length position via Gauss-Legendre quadrature (e.g. `"s(0.5)"`, `"s(68.5%)"`, `"s(100%)"`).
`"<pct>%"`	Shorthand percentage anchor (e.g. `"25%"`, `"50%"`).
`"t-<val>"`, `"s-<val>"`	Alternate dash syntax (e.g. `"t-50"`, `"t-0_5"`, `"s-75"`, `"s-0_75"`).




```
let sp = cs.spline-catmull(((0, 0), (1.5, 2.5),
(3.5, 0.5), (5, 2)))
spline(sp, name: "c", stroke: 2pt +
rgb("#1d3557"))

// Attach labels cleanly using curve normal
angles
circle("c.start", radius: 0.12, fill:
rgb("#0284c7"))
content("c.start", text(size: 7.5pt, weight:
"bold", fill: rgb("#0284c7"))["start"], anchor:
cs.spline-label-anchor(sp, 0.0), padding: 0.15)

circle("c.mid", radius: 0.12, fill:
rgb("#7c3aed"))
content("c.mid", text(size: 7.5pt, weight:
"bold", fill: rgb("#7c3aed"))["mid"], anchor:
cs.spline-label-anchor(sp, 0.5), padding: 0.15)

circle("c.end", radius: 0.12, fill:
rgb("#0284c7"))
content("c.end", text(size: 7.5pt, weight:
"bold", fill: rgb("#0284c7"))["end"], anchor:
cs.spline-label-anchor(sp, 1.0), padding: 0.15)

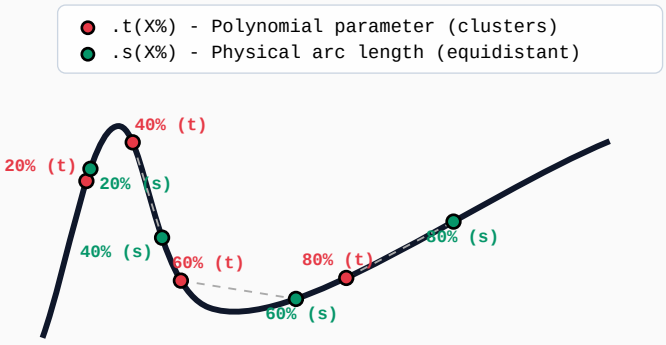
circle("c.pt-1", radius: 0.08, fill: orange)
circle("c.pt-2", radius: 0.08, fill: orange)
```

Parameter Space (`.t()`) vs Arc-Length Space (`.s()`)

A fundamental distinction in differential geometry is the difference between **polynomial parameter space** $t \in [0, 1]$ and **physical arc-length space** $s \in [0, 1]$:

- **Parameter Space (`"t(X%)"`)**: Evaluates the polynomial parameter $t = \frac{X}{100}$. Because cubic segments vary in geometric size and knot spans, equal parameter steps do **not** cover equal physical distances. Points cluster tightly where knot spans are short and spread out on long segments.
- **Arc-Length Space (`"s(X%)"`)**: Evaluates the numerical curve distance $s = \left(\frac{X}{100}\right) \cdot L$ using 5-point Gauss-Legendre numerical quadrature with Newton-Raphson root inversion. Equal arc-length steps are physically equidistant along the curve.

The example below demonstrates this divergence on an asymmetric spline. Instead of hardcoded coordinate offsets, labels are positioned cleanly using the curve's normal angle `cs.spline-normal-angle`, which automatically directs text perpendicular to the tangent at any point:




```
let pts = ((0, 0), (1, 2.8), (2.2, 0.4), (7.5, 2.6))
let sp = cs.spline-catmull(pts, alpha: 0.5)

spline(sp, name: "asym", stroke: 2.2pt + rgb("#0f172a"))

// Compare t(p%) and s(p%) for 20%, 40%, 60%, 80%
for p in (20, 40, 60, 80) {
  let t-val = p / 100.0
  let t-anc = "asym.t(" + str(p) + "%)"
  let s-anc = "asym.s(" + str(p) + "%)"

  let n-ang-t = cs.spline-normal-angle(sp, t-val)
  let t-at-s = cs.spline-t-for-distance(sp, t-val * cs.spline-arc-length(sp))
  let n-ang-s = cs.spline-normal-angle(sp, t-at-s)

  // Connecting drift chord
  line(t-anc, s-anc, stroke: (paint: gray, thickness: 0.7pt, dash: "dashed"))

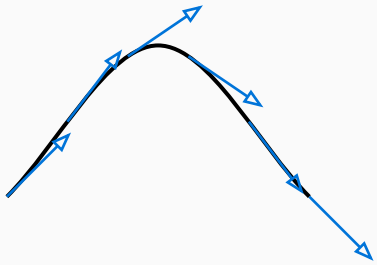
  // Parameter marker (red) positioned along outer normal
  circle(t-anc, radius: 0.09, fill: rgb("#e63946"))
  content(t-anc, text(size: 6.5pt, fill: rgb("#e63946"), weight: "bold")[#str(p)%
(t)], anchor: n-ang-t + 180deg, padding: 0.12)

  // Arc-length marker (teal) positioned along inner normal
  circle(s-anc, radius: 0.09, fill: rgb("#059669"))
  content(s-anc, text(size: 6.5pt, fill: rgb("#059669"), weight: "bold")[#str(p)%
(s)], anchor: n-ang-s, padding: 0.12)
}

// Legend
rect((0.2, 4.4), (8.2, 3.5), stroke: 0.5pt + rgb("#cbd5e1"), fill: rgb("#ffffffa"),
radius: 3pt)
circle((0.6, 4.1), radius: 0.08, fill: rgb("#e63946"))
content((0.9, 4.1), anchor: "west", text(size: 7pt)[.t(X%) - Polynomial parameter
(clusters)])
circle((0.6, 3.75), radius: 0.08, fill: rgb("#059669"))
content((0.9, 3.75), anchor: "west", text(size: 7pt)[.s(X%) - Physical arc length
(equidistant)])
```

```
draw.draw-tangents(
  spline-obj any,
  samples int = 10,
  scale float = 0.4,
  stroke stroke = 0.8pt + rgb("#0074d9")
) → element
```

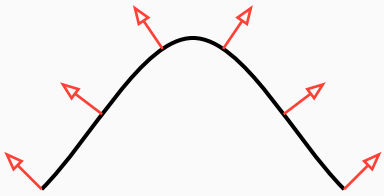
Draws directed unit tangent arrows along the curve.



```
let sp = cs.spline-catmull(((0, 0), (2, 2), (4, 0)))
spline(sp, stroke: 1.5pt + black)
draw-tangents(sp, samples: 6, scale: 1.2, stroke: 1pt + blue)
```

```
draw.draw-normals(
  spline-obj any,
  samples int = 10,
  scale float = 0.4,
  stroke stroke = 0.8pt + rgb("#ff4136")
) → element
```

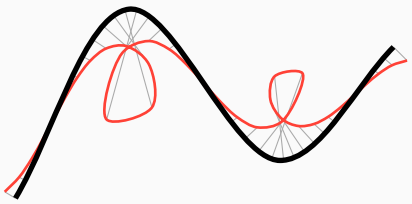
Draws perpendicular oriented left normal vectors along the curve.



```
let sp = cs.spline-catmull(((0, 0), (2, 2), (4, 0)))
spline(sp, stroke: 1.5pt + black)
draw-normals(sp, samples: 6, scale: 0.7, stroke: 1pt + red)
```

```
draw.draw-curvature-comb(
  spline-obj any,
  samples int = 40,
  scale float = 0.5,
  stroke stroke = 0.5pt + luma(66.67%),
  envelope-stroke stroke = 0.8pt + rgb("#0074d9")
) → element
```

Renders CAD-style curvature needles $\kappa(s) \cdot \boldsymbol{N}(s)$ connected by an envelope curve.



```
let sp = cs.spline-catmull(((0, 0), (1.5, 2.5),
(3.5, 0.5), (5, 2)))
draw-curvature-comb(sp, samples: 35, scale: 0.5,
stroke: 0.4pt + gray, envelope-stroke: 1pt +
red)
spline(sp, stroke: 2pt + black)
```

```
draw.draw-homotopy(
  spline-a spline,
  spline-b spline,
  steps int = 5,
  stroke-fn function,
  mode str = "auto",
  samples int, auto = auto
) → element
```

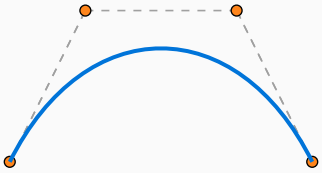
Draws a family of intermediate curves under homotopy deformation. Supports `mode: "auto"`, `"segment"`, or `"arc-length"` to control whether curves are morphed by Bézier control handles or physical arc length.

```
draw.draw-homotopy-field(
  spline-a spline,
  spline-b spline,
  samples int = 8,
  stroke stroke = 0.8pt + rgb("#0074d9"),
  mark dictionary = (end: ">"),
  mode str = "arc-length"
) → element
```

Draws directed deformation vector field arrows connecting curve A to curve B. Supports `mode: "arc-length"` (default: arrows distributed at equal physical curve distances) or `"segment"` (arrows distributed in parameter space).

4.6 Control Handles and Low-Level Helpers

`cs.draw.draw-control-polygon(sp, stroke: (paint: luma(160), thickness: 0.6pt, dash: "dashed"), pt-radius: 0.05, pt-fill: luma(120))` draws each cubic's endpoint handles and the original input polygon. For B-splines, the original polygon is not the same as the extracted cubic handles.



```
let sp = cs.spline-bspline(((0, 0), (1, 2), (3, 2), (4, 0)))
draw-control-polygon(sp, pt-radius: 0.06, pt-fill: orange)
spline(sp, stroke: 1.5pt + blue)
```

The root module also exports the following helpers. They primarily serve custom algorithms and spline construction; use the spline-level functions above for ordinary drawing.

`make-spline`
`is-spline`
`assert-spline`
Build a dictionary with keyword fields shown in the mathematical notes, test the package marker, or assert that marker. Custom segment validity is the caller's responsibility.

`clean-point(pt)`
`clean-points(pts)`
Convert numeric coordinates to floating-point 2D tuples; extra coordinates are discarded.

`segment-count(sp)`
`get-segment(sp, idx)`
Read cubic count or a zero-based segment tuple.

`cubic-point`
`cubic-derivative`
`cubic-second-derivative`
Accept `(s, e, c1, c2, u)` and evaluate a single segment with local parameter `u`.

`cubic-tangent`
`cubic-normal`
`cubic-curvature`
The same five arguments; return a unit tangent, left normal, or signed curvature.

`cubic-tangent-angle`
`cubic-normal-angle`
The same five arguments; return a Typst angle.

`cubic-split(s, e, c1, c2, u)`
Return two CeTZ segment tuples meeting at local parameter `u`.

`segment-arc-length(s, e, c1, c2, u1: 0, u2: 1)`
Numerical oriented length of one segment interval.

`build-arc-length-lut`
`ensure-lut`
`with-lut`
Accept `(sp, samples-per-segment: 10)`; build a lookup table, retrieve an existing table or build one, or return a copy with the table attached. The sample count must be a positive integer.

`spline-normal-at-distance`
`spline-tangent-at-distance`
`spline-tangent-angle-at-distance`
Accept `(sp, distance)`; evaluate the left normal, unit tangent, or tangent angle at an absolute numerical distance.

`generate-clamped-knots(n, p)`
`generate-periodic-knots(n, p)`
Generate knots for `n` original points and degree `p`. Periodic evaluation additionally repeats the first `p` points.

`cox-de-boor(u, p, knots, pts)`
`cox-de-boor-derivative(u, p, knots, pts)`
Evaluate a B-spline or its derivative in the original knot domain, not the equal-segment global parameter.

`catmull-to-bezier-segments`
`bspline-to-bezier-segments`
Accept the corresponding constructor’s arguments and return only the array of cubic tuples.

5 Examples Gallery

5.1 Aerodynamic Airfoil Profile & Curvature Comb

An illustrative airfoil outline, rather than a physical flow model. The comb shows where geometric curvature changes abruptly or becomes large; it does not calculate pressure or aerodynamic acceleration. Try reducing `scale` if the needles obscure the profile.




```
let upper-pts = ((0, 0), (0.35, 0.65), (1.2, 0.88), (2.8, 0.68), (4.5, 0.22), (5.5,
0))
let lower-pts = ((0, 0), (0.5, -0.35), (1.8, -0.38), (3.4, -0.22), (5.5, 0))

let upper = cs.spline-catmull(upper-pts, alpha: 0.5)
let lower = cs.spline-catmull(lower-pts, alpha: 0.5)

// Curvature comb on suction surface
draw-curvature-comb(
  upper,
  samples: 45,
  scale: 0.6,
  stroke: 0.4pt + luma(180),
  envelope-stroke: 1.2pt + rgb("#ef4444"),
  fill: rgb("#ef444415"),
)

// Airfoil body
spline(upper, name: "suction", stroke: 2pt + rgb("#0f172a"))
spline(lower, name: "pressure", stroke: 2pt + rgb("#0f172a"))

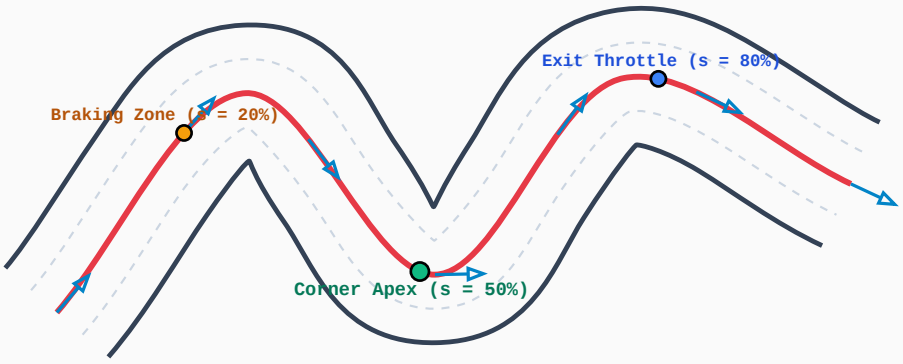
// Chord reference line
line("suction.start", "suction.end", stroke: (paint: gray, thickness: 0.6pt, dash:
"dashed"))

// Annotations
circle("suction.start", radius: 0.08, fill: rgb("#0284c7"))
content("suction.start", text(size: 7pt, weight: "bold")[Leading Edge], anchor:
"north-east", padding: 0.15)

circle("suction.end", radius: 0.08, fill: rgb("#0284c7"))
content("suction.end", text(size: 7pt, weight: "bold")[Trailing Edge], anchor:
"north-west", padding: 0.15)
```

5.2 High-Speed Racetrack Corner & Banking Lanes

Generating a racing line chicane with parallel track boundaries and curbs using `cs.offset`. Braking, apex, and acceleration points are positioned at numerical arc-length distances using `"s(X%)"` anchors.




```
let track-pts = ((-4, -1.5), (-1.5, 1.4), (1, -1.0), (3.5, 1.6), (6.5, 0.2))
let racing-line = cs.spline-catmull(track-pts, alpha: 0.5)

// Track borders via parallel offset
let outer-kerb = cs.offset(racing-line, 0.9)
let inner-kerb = cs.offset(racing-line, -0.9)
let left-lane = cs.offset(racing-line, 0.45)
let right-lane = cs.offset(racing-line, -0.45)

spline(outer-kerb, stroke: 1.8pt + rgb("#334155"))
spline(left-lane, stroke: (paint: rgb("#cbd5e1"), thickness: 0.8pt, dash: "dashed"))
spline(racing-line, name: "race", stroke: 2.2pt + rgb("#e63946"))
spline(right-lane, stroke: (paint: rgb("#cbd5e1"), thickness: 0.8pt, dash: "dashed"))
spline(inner-kerb, stroke: 1.8pt + rgb("#334155"))

// Tangent vectors showing vehicle heading
draw-tangents(racing-line, samples: 7, scale: 0.7, stroke: 1.2pt + rgb("#0284c7"))

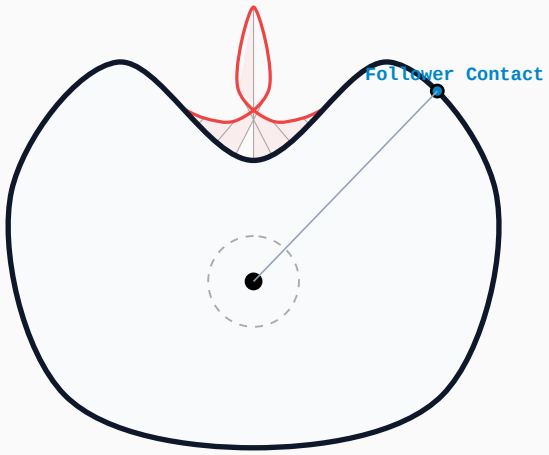
// Arc-length key positions oriented along curve normals
circle("race.s(20%)", radius: 0.1, fill: rgb("#f59e0b"))
content("race.s(20%)", text(size: 6.5pt, weight: "bold", fill: rgb("#b45309"))
[Braking Zone (s = 20%)], anchor: cs.spline-label-anchor-at-distance(racing-line,
cs.spline-arc-length(racing-line) * 0.2), padding: 0.12)

circle("race.s(50%)", radius: 0.12, fill: rgb("#10b981"))
content("race.s(50%)", text(size: 7pt, weight: "bold", fill: rgb("#047857"))[Corner
Apex (s = 50%)], anchor: cs.spline-label-anchor-at-distance(racing-line, cs.spline-
arc-length(racing-line) * 0.5, side: -1), padding: 0.15)

circle("race.s(80%)", radius: 0.1, fill: rgb("#3b82f6"))
content("race.s(80%)", text(size: 6.5pt, weight: "bold", fill: rgb("#1d4ed8"))[Exit
Throttle (s = 80%)], anchor: cs.spline-label-anchor-at-distance(racing-line,
cs.spline-arc-length(racing-line) * 0.8), padding: 0.12)
```

5.3 Mechanical Cam Profile & Roller Follower

A closed C^2 cam profile evaluated with `draw-curvature-comb`. The needle spikes $\kappa(s) \cdot \boldsymbol{N}(s)$ and envelope verify acceleration smoothness, while a roller follower is positioned along the normal contact point.




```
let pts = (
  (0, 1.6), (1.8, 2.9), (3.2, 1.2), (2.5, -1.5),
  (0, -2.2), (-2.5, -1.5), (-3.2, 1.2), (-1.8, 2.9),
)
let cam = cs.spline-catmull(pts, alpha: 0.5, closed: true)

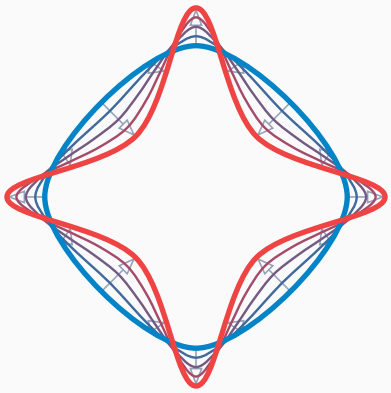
// Curvature comb
draw-curvature-comb(
  cam,
  samples: 60,
  scale: 0.8,
  stroke: 0.4pt + luma(170),
  envelope-stroke: 1.2pt + rgb("#ef4444"),
  fill: rgb("#ef444412"),
)

// Cam body & base circle
spline(cam, name: "cam-body", stroke: 2pt + rgb("#0f172a"), fill: rgb("#f8fafc"))
circle((0, 0), radius: 0.1, fill: black)
circle((0, 0), radius: 0.6, stroke: (paint: gray, thickness: 0.7pt, dash: "dashed"))

// Roller follower at peak displacement (s = 15%)
let follower-contact = "cam-body.s(15%)"
circle(follower-contact, radius: 0.08, fill: rgb("#0284c7"))
line((0, 0), follower-contact, stroke: 0.6pt + rgb("#94a3b8"))
content(follower-contact, text(size: 7pt, weight: "bold", fill: rgb("#0284c7"))
[Follower Contact], anchor: cs.spline-label-anchor-at-distance(cam, cs.spline-arc-
length(cam) * 0.15), padding: 0.15)
```

5.4 Shape Morphing (Homotopy Family & Flow Field)

Continuous linear homotopy $(1-t)A + tB$ morphing between an elliptical teardrop profile and an undulating 4-lobed profile. The arrows connect corresponding sample positions and show displacement; they do not represent a physical flow or flux.



```
let circle-pts = ((0, 2), (2, 0), (0, -2), (-2, 0))
let lobe-pts = ((0, 2.5), (0.8, 0.8), (2.5, 0), (0.8, -0.8), (0, -2.5), (-0.8, -0.8),
(-2.5, 0), (-0.8, 0.8))

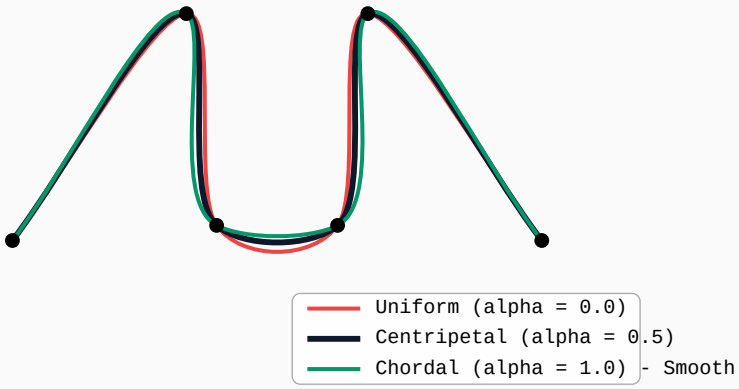
let base-shape = cs.spline-catmull(circle-pts, closed: true)
let target-shape = cs.spline-catmull(lobe-pts, closed: true)

// Deformation arrows and intermediate morph family
draw-homotopy-field(base-shape, target-shape, samples: 16, stroke: 0.6pt +
rgb("#94a3b8"))
draw-homotopy(
  base-shape,
  target-shape,
  steps: 4,
  stroke-fn: (t) => 0.9pt + rgb(int(15 + t * 200), int(120 - t * 60), int(180 - t *
100)),
)

spline(base-shape, stroke: 2pt + rgb("#0284c7"))
spline(target-shape, stroke: 2pt + rgb("#ef4444"))
```

5.5 Knot Exponent Comparison (α)

Comparison of uniform ($\alpha = 0.0$), centripetal ($\alpha = 0.5$), and chordal ($\alpha = 1.0$) Catmull-Rom parameterization over unevenly spaced control points. Compare the different bulges around the closely spaced points. Centripetal parameterization avoids within-segment cusps for distinct consecutive points; a uniform curve need not exhibit a cusp for every input.




```
let pts = ((-3.5, 0), (-1.2, 3), (-0.8, 0.2), (0.8, 0.2), (1.2, 3), (3.5, 0))
let sp-uni = cs.spline-catmull(pts, alpha: 0.0)
let sp-cent = cs.spline-catmull(pts, alpha: 0.5)
let sp-chord = cs.spline-catmull(pts, alpha: 1.0)

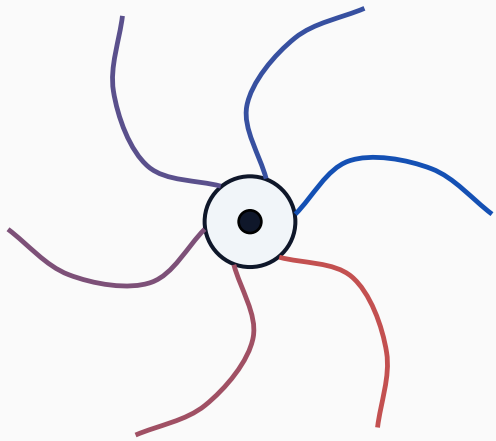
spline(sp-uni, stroke: 1.5pt + rgb("#ef4444"))
spline(sp-cent, stroke: 2.2pt + rgb("#0f172a"))
spline(sp-chord, stroke: 1.5pt + rgb("#059669"))

for p in pts { circle(p, radius: 0.08, fill: black) }

// Legend
rect((0.2, -0.7), (4.8, -1.9), stroke: 0.5pt + gray, fill: rgb("#ffffffa"), radius:
3pt)
line((0.4, -0.9), (1.1, -0.9), stroke: 1.5pt + rgb("#ef4444"))
content((1.3, -0.9), anchor: "west", text(size: 7.5pt)[Uniform (alpha = 0.0)])
line((0.4, -1.3), (1.1, -1.3), stroke: 2.2pt + rgb("#0f172a"))
content((1.3, -1.3), anchor: "west", text(size: 7.5pt)[Centripetal (alpha = 0.5)])
line((0.4, -1.7), (1.1, -1.7), stroke: 1.5pt + rgb("#059669"))
content((1.3, -1.7), anchor: "west", text(size: 7.5pt)[Chordal (alpha = 1.0) -
Smooth])
```

5.6 Turbomachinery Rotor Symmetry via Rotational Transforms

A single master blade profile rotated symmetrically around a central hub using `cs.rotate-spline`. Because Bézier control handles transform rigidly under affine transformations, symmetry and arc lengths are preserved exactly.



```
let blade-pts = ((0.6, 0.1), (1.3, 0.8), (2.4, 0.7), (3.2, 0.1))
let blade = cs.spline-catmull(blade-pts, alpha: 0.5)

// Central hub
circle((0, 0), radius: 0.6, stroke: 1.5pt + rgb("#0f172a"), fill: rgb("#f1f5f9"))
circle((0, 0), radius: 0.15, fill: rgb("#0f172a"))

// 6-blade rotor cascade
for i in range(6) {
  let rot-blade = cs.rotate-spline(blade, i * 60deg, origin: (0, 0))
  let clr = rgb(int(20 + i * 35), 80, int(180 - i * 20))
  spline(rot-blade, stroke: 1.8pt + clr)
}
```

6 Mathematical Notes

6.1 Spline Data Representation

Every curve in `cetz-spline` is represented by an immutable dictionary:

```
#let make-spline(
  type: "catmull-rom",       // "catmull-rom" | "bspline" | "homotopy" | "offset"
  pts: (),                   // Array of original input points
  closed: false,             // bool
  meta: (:),                 // Spline parameters (alpha, degree, knots, etc.)
  segments: (),              // Array of native CeTZ cubic Bézier segments ((s, e, c1,
c2), ...)
  lut: none,                 // Cached arc-length lookup table
)
```

Each segment inside `segments` follows CeTZ's standard Bézier tuple:

$$(\boldsymbol{s}, \boldsymbol{e}, \boldsymbol{c}_1, \boldsymbol{c}_2)$$

where $\boldsymbol{s}$ is the starting point, $\boldsymbol{e}$ is the end point, and $\boldsymbol{c}_1, \boldsymbol{c}_2$ are control handles.

6.2 Centripetal Catmull-Rom Parameterization

For four consecutive interpolation points $\boldsymbol{P}_0, \boldsymbol{P}_1, \boldsymbol{P}_2, \boldsymbol{P}_3$, knot intervals are computed as:

$$t_0 = 0, \quad t_{i+1} = t_i + \|\boldsymbol{P}_{i+1} - \boldsymbol{P}_i\|^{\alpha}$$

where:

- $\alpha = 0.0$: Uniform Catmull-Rom. Susceptible to self-intersections and cusps when distance between adjacent points varies significantly.
- $\alpha = 0.5$: Centripetal Catmull-Rom (default). Proven by Yuksel et al. (2011) to be cusp-free and self-intersection-free within segments.
- $\alpha = 1.0$: Chordal Catmull-Rom. Knots are proportional to Euclidean chord length.

The Bézier control points between $\boldsymbol{P}_1$ and $\boldsymbol{P}_2$ are obtained by evaluating the endpoint derivatives:

$$\boldsymbol{B}_0 = \boldsymbol{P}_1$$

$$\boldsymbol{B}_1 = \boldsymbol{P}_1 + \frac{t_2 - t_1}{3}\left[\frac{t_2 - t_1}{t_2 - t_0}\frac{\boldsymbol{P}_1 - \boldsymbol{P}_0}{t_1 - t_0} + \frac{t_1 - t_0}{t_2 - t_0}\frac{\boldsymbol{P}_2 - \boldsymbol{P}_1}{t_2 - t_1}\right]$$

$$\boldsymbol{B}_2 = \boldsymbol{P}_2 - \frac{t_2 - t_1}{3}\left[\frac{t_3 - t_2}{t_3 - t_1}\frac{\boldsymbol{P}_2 - \boldsymbol{P}_1}{t_2 - t_1} + \frac{t_2 - t_1}{t_3 - t_1}\frac{\boldsymbol{P}_3 - \boldsymbol{P}_2}{t_3 - t_2}\right]$$

$$\boldsymbol{B}_3 = \boldsymbol{P}_2$$

6.3 Curvature and Normal Vectors

The unit tangent vector is $\boldsymbol{T}(u) = \frac{C'(u)}{\|C'(u)\|}$. The oriented left unit normal vector $\boldsymbol{N}(u)$ points 90 degrees counter-clockwise from $\boldsymbol{T}(u)$:

$$\boldsymbol{N}(u) = \left(-T_{y(u)}, T_{x(u)}\right)$$

Signed scalar curvature $\kappa(u)$ is:

$$\kappa(u) = \frac{x'(u)y''(u) - y'(u)x''(u)}{(x'(u)^2 + y'(u)^2)^{\frac{3}{2}}}$$

Curvature is positive when the curve bends to the left (counter-clockwise) and negative when bending to the right (clockwise).

6.4 Arc-Length Quadrature and Inversion

Curve speed $\|C'(t)\|$ varies along polynomial splines. Arc length between parameters a and b is evaluated using 5-point Gauss-Legendre quadrature:

$$\int_a^b \|C'(u)\|\, du \approx \frac{b-a}{2} \sum_{i=1}^{5} w_i \, \|C'\left(\frac{a+b}{2} + \frac{b-a}{2} x_i\right)\|$$

with weights and abscissae:

$$x_1 = 0, \quad w_1 = \frac{128}{225} \approx 0.568889$$

$$x_{2,3} = \pm\sqrt{\frac{5 - 2\sqrt{\frac{10}{7}}}{9}} \approx \pm 0.538469, \quad w_{2,3} = \frac{322 + 13\sqrt{70}}{900} \approx 0.478629$$

$$x_{4,5} = \pm\sqrt{\frac{5 + 2\sqrt{\frac{10}{7}}}{9}} \approx \pm 0.906180, \quad w_{4,5} = \frac{322 - 13\sqrt{70}}{900} \approx 0.236927$$

The implementation adaptively compares each interval with two half intervals, up to a bounded refinement depth. These are numerical estimates, not exact lengths or certified error bounds. Cached lookup tables avoid repeated work when explicitly attached with `cs.with-lut(sp)`.

To map physical distance s back to parameter t, a bracketed Newton iteration is performed, with bisection when the Newton step leaves the bracket:

$$u_{k+1} = u_k - \frac{s(u_k) - s_{\text{target}}}{\|C'(u_k)\|}$$

6.5 Parameterization and Continuity

Global t assigns equal parameter intervals to the stored cubic segments. It does not preserve the original nonuniform B-spline knot parameter or the Catmull–Rom knot times. Position is continuous at joins, but derivatives with respect to global t can jump. For nonuniform Catmull–Rom splines, tangent direction is continuous at regular joins; tangent magnitude need not be. Curvature and second derivatives can also jump. At a join, evaluation uses the segment on the right, except at $t = 1$.

The left normal is defined by orientation, even at inflections; it is not the principal oriented left normal, which changes sign with curvature. At a stationary point the mathematical tangent and curvature may be undefined. The implementation tries a nearby derivative for the tangent, then uses $(1, 0)$ as a fallback; curvature returns zero below its speed threshold. Treat those values as drawing conventions.

6.6 Approximation Limits

B-splines of degree one through three convert to cubic segments exactly up to floating-point rounding. Higher degrees use piecewise cubic Hermite approximation with `degree - 2` pieces per knot span; no error tolerance is currently exposed. Custom interior knot multiplicity may not exceed the effective degree: discontinuous curves are rejected.

`cs.offset` approximates a normal offset by matching endpoint positions and scaled tangent handles. A single split may improve a segment with differing endpoint curvatures, but does not guarantee an error bound, remove intersections, or construct joins at corners. At distances near a curvature radius, the true offset can develop singularities. Use modest distances and inspect the result.

The centripetal guarantee concerns individual regular segments with distinct consecutive points, not global intersections between different segments. Repeated points are handled numerically, but are outside that guarantee. See Yuksel, Schaefer, and Keyser, *On the Parameterization of Catmull–Rom Curves* for the precise result.